Finance Data Studio

A self-service front door for certified finance data

Publish once. Request in plain words. Consume as yourself.

James Shin · Proposal for Reddit Finance Technology · September 2026

Three steps take a dataset from publish to self-served, certified use

1 Publish 2 Request 3 Consume

1 PUBLISH

Chat with an agent to describe your dataset, upload a sample export; the Studio generates the intake for pipeline, marts, and receipts.

2 REQUEST

Search for existing relevant SOX-certified datasets, request access, with permission granularity to column level.

3 CONSUME

Ask a question directly in Studio, import to Looker, Hex projects or export to Excel; every read runs under your name.

WHAT MOVES

−50%

recon and accrual prep hours

e.g. the PO accrual: two days to two hours

0 tickets

to get certified data

a steward decides on a visible clock; access is a row with an expiry

100%

of loads carry a receipt

a silent feed pages its owner within 15 minutes

Pain points, solved by Finance Data Studio

1 Publish | 2 Request | 3 Consume

1 PUBLISH

THE PROBLEM TODAY

- Data leaves the ERP by hand, feed by feed.
- Alerting sits across tools; one person keeps it running.

WHAT WE BUILD

One Confirm publishes a dataset. The spec, pipeline, and certification follow.

One morning board. It says whether the data is in; silence pages the owner.

2 REQUEST

THE PROBLEM TODAY

- No finance mart; the data sits in each system.
- Access by cost center is the hardest permission to run.

WHAT WE BUILD

One certified catalog. One search, and no re-checking the numbers.

Access down to the column. Every query runs as the person who asked.

3 CONSUME

THE PROBLEM TODAY

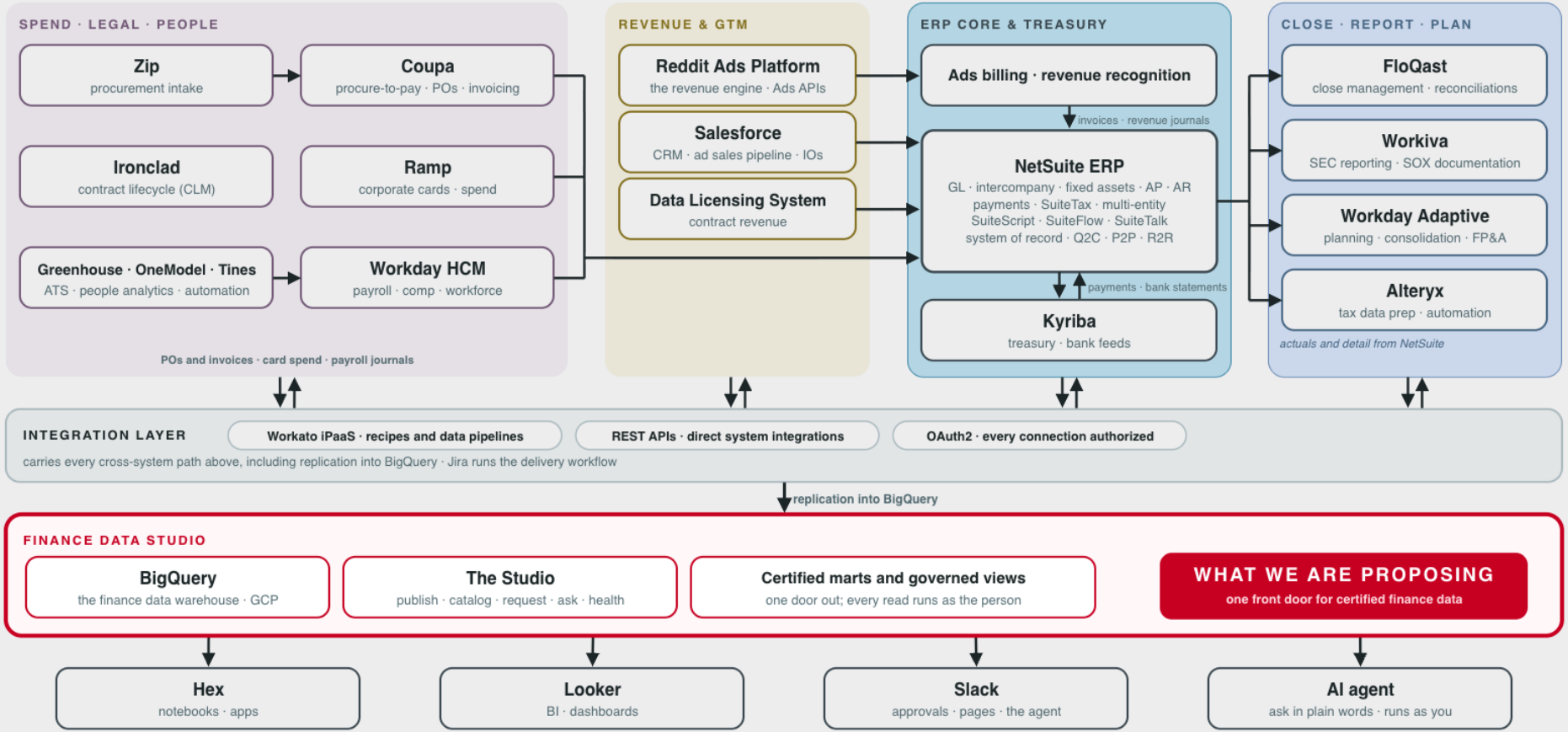
- Recons start from zero; the accrual is copy and paste.
- Finance wants to self-serve, AI included.

WHAT WE BUILD

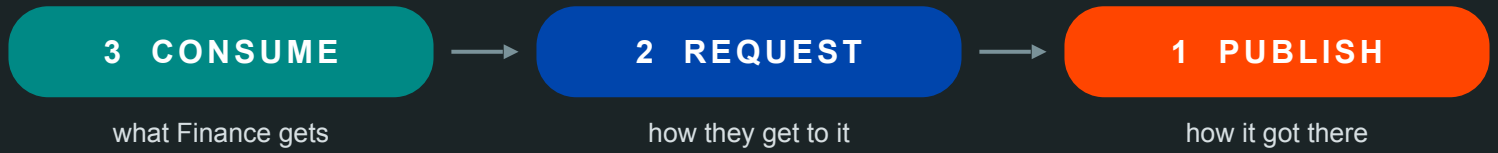
Reconciliation by exception. Both sides pre-joined; Finance builds the view in Hex.

AI with guardrails. Always as the person, with an audit trail.

Reddit Enterprise Systems Landscape



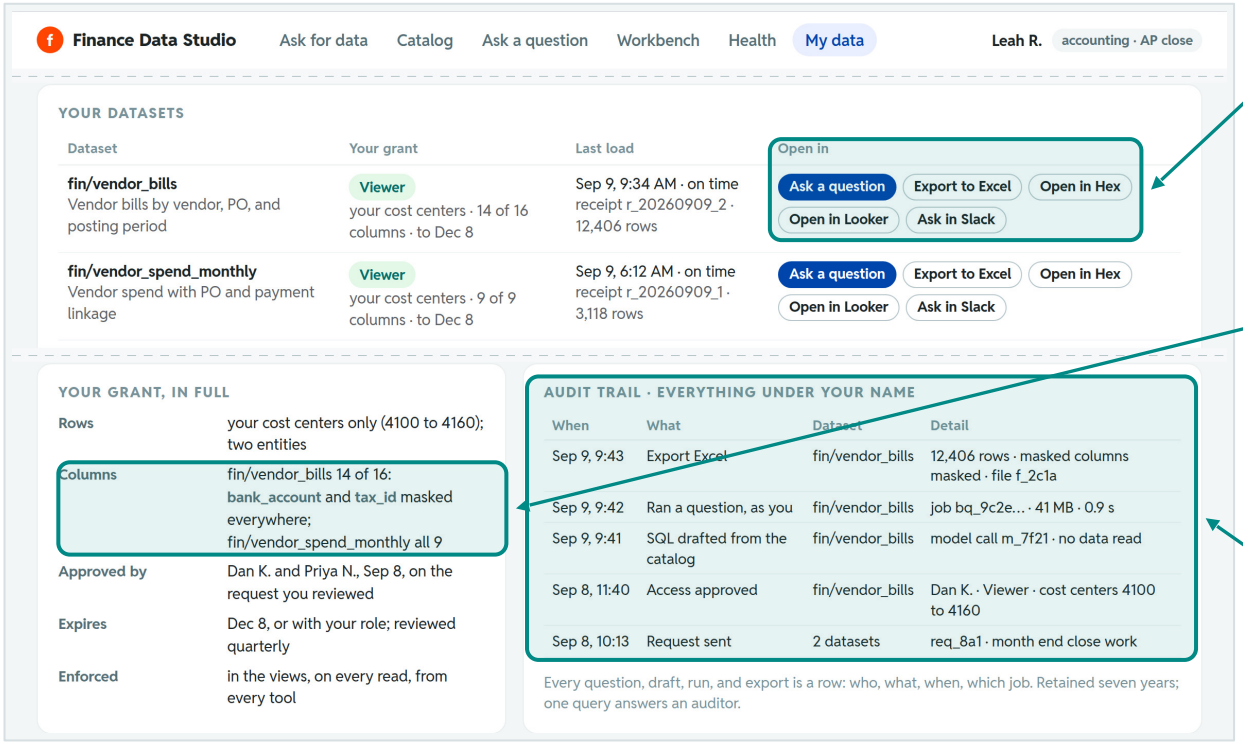
Start where the work happens.



Three pages on what Finance does with certified data. Then the two that make it possible.

Approved data opens where people already work

1 Publish — 2 Request — 3 Consume

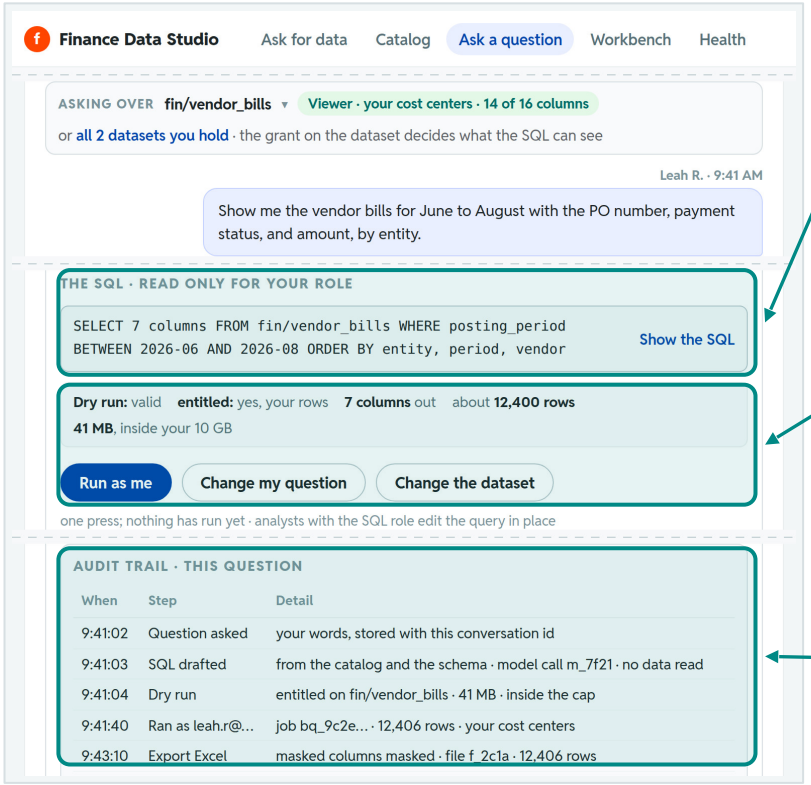


1 **Five doors.** Ask a question here or in Slack, open in Hex or Looker, or export to Excel.

2 **Access with column granularity.** Permissions sit on the columns themselves, so nobody builds a masked copy.

3 **Audit trail.** Every question, run, and export under your name; one query answers an auditor.

A question to an AI Agent becomes a table the person runs as their role



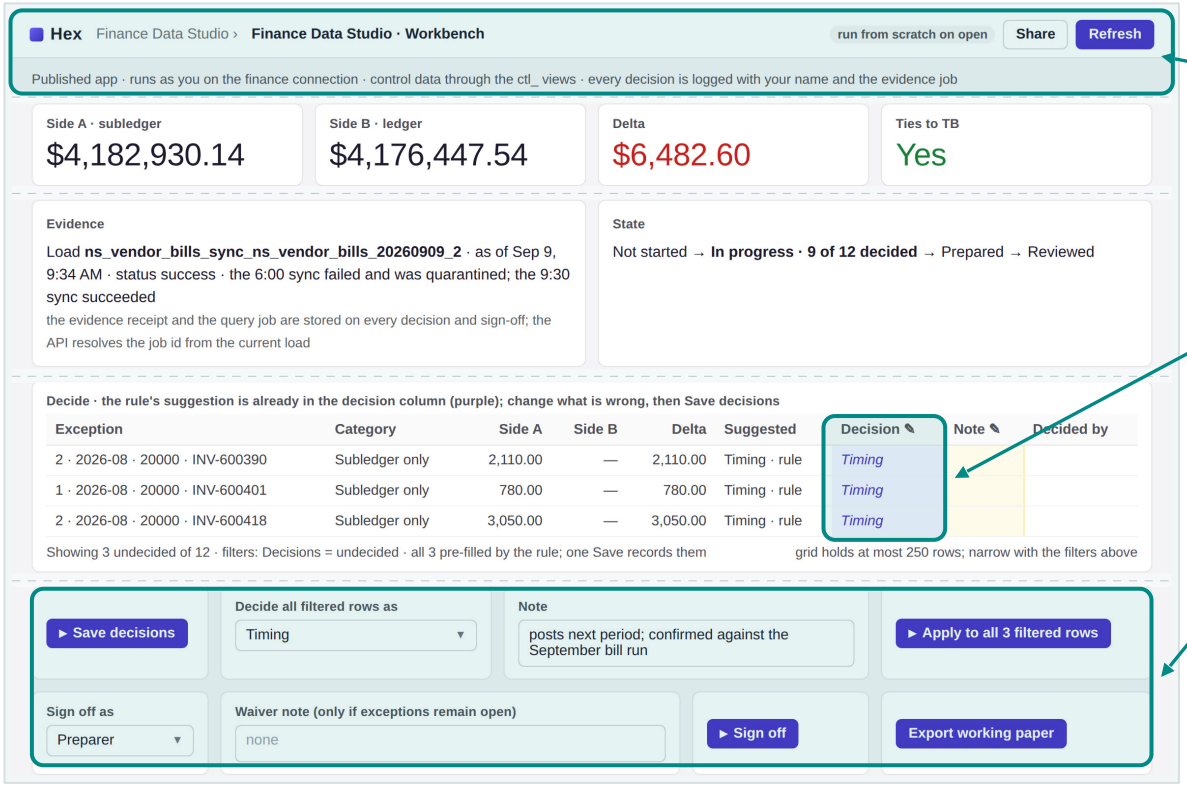
1. **MCP calls only.** The agent reads the catalog and schema through the platform's tools and drafts one SELECT. AI never touches source data.

2. **Always runs as the user.** No service accounts, full auditability to role and user.

3. **Audit trail retained.** Question, draft, dry run, run, and export each leave a row under your name with the job id.

Example reconciliation dashboard built by Hex, enabled by Finance Data Studio

1 Publish — 2 Request — 3 Consume



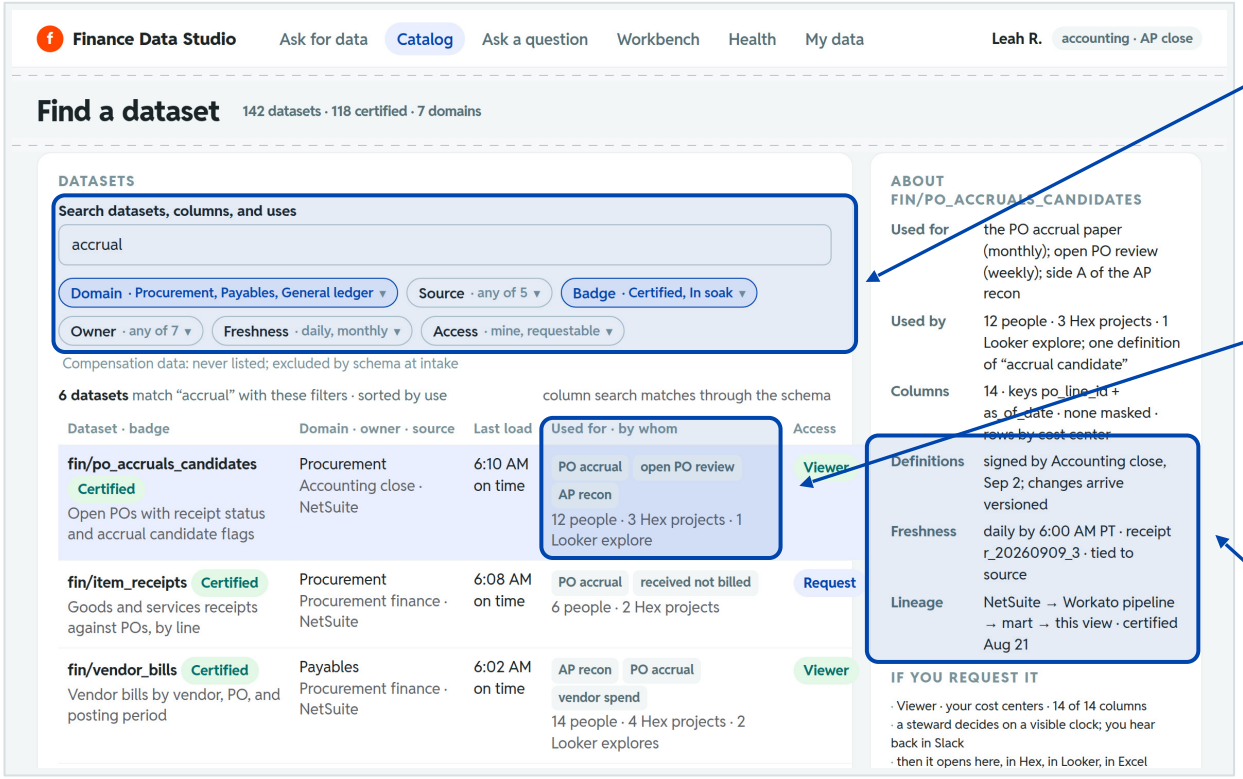
1. **A Hex app on the certified views.** Built with Finance after MVP-1; runs as the person.

2. **The rule decides first.** The preparer changes only what it got wrong; bulk decisions cover sets.

3. **One Save, one Sign off.** The evidence on the record; the reviewer gets a link.

Any certified dataset is one search away, with its use cases and its access

1 Publish | **2 Request** | 3 Consume

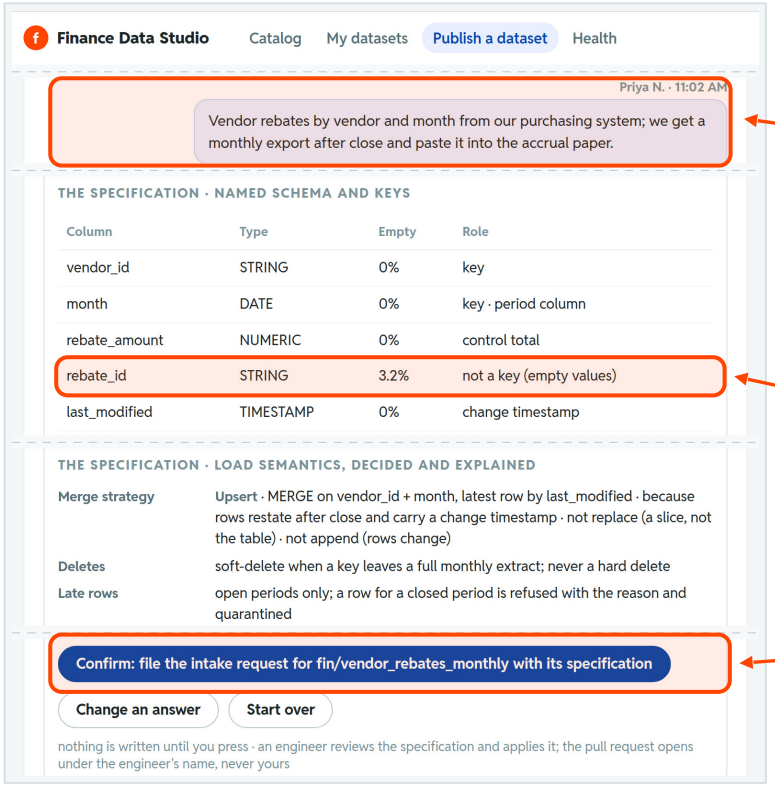


1 **One catalog, filtered.** Search by name, column, or use; filter by domain, source, badge, owner, access.

2 **Use cases on the row.** What each dataset is used for, and by whom.

3 **Certified means no re-checking.** The numbers tie to the books, someone owns them, and the audit proof is already there.

An agent guides the producer through onboarding: one export, one Confirm



1. **Describe and upload.** A sentence, one export; the agent drafts nine answers and holds no role.

2. **Edit, never author.** Fix what the draft got wrong; a bad key is refused at once.

3. **One Confirm.** It files a spec: named schema, keys, upsert or replace; an engineer applies it.

Two people, four months: one dataset live in week 8, three by week 15

WHAT LANDS WHEN

wk 3
Discovery out
baselines, a steward, GL lines chosen, the access model

wk 6
The spine
GL pipeline, marts, receipts; CI; the Studio behind sign-in

wk 8
MVP-1: one dataset, the whole loop
GL lines certified, found, requested, asked, opened in Hex

wk 12
Three datasets
onboarded by their owners; the health page; the gate review

wk 15
Go-live
three datasets in use; hypercare to week 17

THE PHASES, AS THE PROGRAM SPEC CUTS THEM



WHO BUILDS IT

Two people, full time. The architect (this role) and one infrastructure engineer; nothing is hand-built per feed.

WHAT FINANCE PROVIDES

A data owner, named in week one; the first recon in Hex during UAT; subject-matter hours outside close weeks.

Technical architecture: GCP-hosted, Workato lanes in, governed views out

